II

Tibet: The Price of Friendship

The first major negotiation following the establishment of diplomatic relations was on the issue of Tibet. It was the core issue in India–China relations almost from the establishment of the People's Republic of China. It culminated in the signing of the Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between the Tibet Region of China and India on 29 April 1954. The Chinese Communists had already declared their intention of expelling the Nationalists from all parts of China after the end of the Second World War, and uniting the country, including its minorities, under New China. More than one source has confirmed that it was Mao Zedong's intention to launch a military campaign on Tibet immediately after the new Republic was formally established. The Chinese Communists were aware of the attempt of the Tibetan authorities to seek independence for Tibet from China with the support of India and the West. They felt that after independence, India was continuing to pursue the British imperialist policy with regard to Tibet.